MONTHLY UPDATE

Congo: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-19 · 35 systems and instruments tracked, 12 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-19 — July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

Two compulsory revenue systems came into effect within five weeks. Certified electronic invoicing became mandatory for every economic agent on 1 July 2026, and on 3 August the public-revenue platform went live for online payment of taxes, levies and customs duties, on an order that makes it the sole lawful channel. The treasury single account meant to centralise those receipts was still being finalised on the day the platform opened.

The country's cybersecurity strategy and national training plan went out to open international tender on 23 July, bids closing 2 September, financed by a European bank through the transformation project. The country has had a cybersecurity agency since 2019 and neither document exists.

A ministerial adviser published a digital roadmap of five ambitions and nine programmes on 28 July, with delivery placed in an interministerial task force. It is a signed opinion piece, not an adopted instrument.

Infrastructure

Connectivity

Two positions describe the same weakness from either end. The country has relied on one submarine cable since 2012, with a switch to another announced as three weeks away after weeks of outages — six months on, no source confirms any new cable carrying traffic. Behind it, mobile backhaul spectrum fees run at about 5% of operators' total revenue against a sub-Saharan median of 0.5%, alongside delayed spectrum assignments and technology-neutrality restrictions. Backhaul is the default rural link where fibre does not reach, so the premium falls hardest where coverage is weakest, and no regulatory response is on file.

Data Storage

The published roadmap names sovereign hosting and connectivity at the two highest tiers among its infrastructure programmes; neither exists, with no standing-up instrument, host body, budget or date.

The national data centre remains a thing asserted rather than reported. On 10 August the state operator showed the minister a real-time security operations centre running across its Brazzaville, Pointe-Noire and Oyo data centres, alongside nationwide fibre connectivity for citizens, businesses and state bodies. It is the fullest description of the operator's estate the base holds, and it is still a ministerial visit rather than an inauguration report: no capacity, certification or utilisation figure is given for any of the three sites, and nothing reconciles it with the works reported suspended at 95% completion in late 2025.

Cybersecurity

It launched an open international tender on 23 July for a 24-month mission to draft the national cybersecurity strategy, a national training plan and national conferences, scope covering a sector diagnostic, a strategic roadmap and a standing forum; no contract value is published. On 28 July it validated a consolidated draft setting qualification conditions for bodies authorised to audit information systems nationally, with no adoption instrument, publication date or entry into force stated. Its largest operational mandate arrived through tax legislation: a decree of 31 March, published 9 July, puts the agency into joint homologation of every invoicing terminal, software and enterprise module; it awards the security label and conformity identifier, audits the infrastructure and takes 15% of homologation fees. The same roadmap also names a national security operations centre and response team among its infrastructure programmes; it does not exist either.

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

Regionally, an interoperable QR-code standard launched at Douala on 29 July, letting any application scan any merchant code across the six member states; no country-specific adoption figure is held. The same roadmap names an inter-administration data exchange platform among three digital public infrastructure foundations.

One exchange did go into use, in the narrow place where the state examines itself. The national transparency commission opened the second round of its public-finance transparency-code evaluation entirely online, covering budget years 2023 to 2025, with focal-point training completed in Brazzaville on 15 July with UNDP support. No supplier, custodian or results publication date is stated, and the platform is not publicly accessible on the record held.

Digital Identity and CRVS

The same roadmap names secure digital identity and a wallet among three digital public infrastructure foundations, with no standing-up instrument, budget or date.

Digital Payments and Fintech

On 3 August the public-revenue platform went live on the national payments switch, payment following a declaration, authenticated, reconciled in real time and routed to the treasury against a secured electronic receipt. Roll-out runs at large then medium enterprises, all taxpayers targeted by end-2026 and no wave dates published. The same account records the treasury single account at the regional central bank still being finalised.

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

The minister recorded on 10 July that the regulator has run the postal addressing project for two years and the ministry has not taken it up for deployment, his own framing being that without the handover the work has not had the expected impact.

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

Health acquired equipment rather than a system. On 7 August the Global Fund and UNDP handed over e-health equipment, a P2-level biosafety laboratory and a secure biomedical-waste management system at the Edith Lucie Bongo Ondimba hospital at Oyo, for early disease detection, patient data management and health-service coordination. It is a single site; no value, system name, national rollout or interoperability with any other health system is stated, and it sits beside a civil-service payroll platform whose own operator has minuted three failure modes.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Compulsory electronic invoicing took effect on 1 July for every economic agent except the state, local authorities on public-service missions and diplomatic bodies, three months after its enabling decree, with no phase-in by firm size and no assisted or offline route stated on the accounts held. On the same date a user guide for the tax filing portal fixed filing regimes, delegation and irreversible submission: one delegate at a time, the legal representative's own rights removed for the duration, and no correction route once a return is sent. The same roadmap commits civil status, passport, criminal record and company creation as digitised priority services within two years.

National statistics

One statistical build opened: the quarterly labour-market and informal-sector survey entered its preparatory phase, with four series of indicators a year planned — a first for the country — and no fieldwork date, sample or budget stated.

Use of satellite data

The national mapping institute began putting its own holdings into a usable form. On 11 August it signed a framework partnership with a local non-governmental organisation to digitise, secure and disseminate its geospatial and cartographic data, building a shared platform for public, institutional and research access. It is a framework agreement rather than a delivered platform: no term, funding, licence or access rule is stated, and nothing says what is currently held or in what form.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

The invoicing regime was completed in the gazette. The decree signed 31 March was gazetted on 9 July and is compulsory from 1 July, and four implementing orders signed 9 July and gazetted 16 July fix a four-stage homologation with a 30-day decision deadline, mandatory cryptographic certification, a penetration test under twelve months old, a sworn no-backdoor attestation, ten-year invoice retention and real-time tax-directorate data access. Fees are FCFA 5,000,000 per terminal model and per software version, split 75% state, 15% security agency and 10% standards body; foreign suppliers must be locally represented.

Strategies, plans and policies

A public-finance digital transformation steering committee met for the first time on 15 July, chaired by the minister and seating the directors-general of the revenue authorities, on improving revenue collection, securing public funds and raising the quality of public spending. And the ministry's roadmap places delivery in an interministerial task force under the Prime Minister rather than the ministry acting alone; a separate nine-point ministerial list of 10 July is not reconciled with it.

Regional collaboration

Namibia's cabinet approved an ICT cooperation memorandum and authorised its minister to sign; no Congolese source, approval step or text is held.

EU activities

An exploratory session on 14 July opened a channel with a European member-state development bank under the European gateway programme, with no commitment, sum or timetable named.

Open data

Focal points were trained on 14 and 15 July on a platform under development to carry the 2023, 2024 and 2025 assessments, the workshop's recommendations being laptops, rechargeable routers and functional websites for covered entities.

Inclusion and capacity

Training and skills

The national cybersecurity training plan is inside that tender. The country has neither a strategy nor a training plan, and both are being written under a donor-financed contract whose value is not published.

Finance

New investments

The European phase of the transformation project, launched in June 2025 with EUR 36.3m of loan and FCFA 10bn of grant committed, made its first named procurement in July — the same 24-month cybersecurity mission — with no procurement held before now.

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

Both chambers adopted the rectifying finance law unanimously and unamended on 23 July, lifting expenditure to FCFA 2,561.069bn against revenue of FCFA 2,778.016bn for a projected surplus of FCFA 216.947bn. It rests on re-pricing the barrel at US$67 from US$60.3 with output held flat; the first of its four objectives is consolidating public revenue through digitalisation, and no revised figure for the digital vote is published. It was adopted but not gazetted at the date of this issue.

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